NORTHSTAR DIGITAL SERVICES LTD.

People Operations · Finance · Information Security

Leave Policy (Archived)

Historical record — superseded on 1 October 2026

SUPERSEDED — NOT FOR CURRENT POLICY DECISIONS

Document ID	NDS-HR-LV-006
Version	1.0
Status	SUPERSEDED — archived
Effective from	1 January 2025
Effective to	30 September 2026
Next review date	Not applicable (archived)
Policy owner	Head of People Services (at time of issue)
Approved by	Executive Leadership Team, 4 December 2024
Applies to	Historical reference only
Jurisdiction	England and Wales
Classification	Internal (ARCHIVED)

SUPERSEDED — NOT FOR CURRENT POLICY DECISIONS

This Leave Policy NDS-HR-LV-006 version 1.0 was effective from **1 January 2025 to 30 September 2026**. It was superseded on **1 October 2026** by the Leave and Absence Standard NDS-HR-LAS-002 v1.2 and the Employee Handbook NDS-HR-HB-001 v2.0.

It is retained for historical reference only: for example, to check what rule applied to leave taken, or a request submitted, before 1 October 2026. Do not use it to answer questions about current entitlements or for any decision about leave requested on or after 1 October 2026. Where this document and a current document differ, the current document applies to any date on or after 1 October 2026.

1 Purpose and scope (historical)

This policy set out the annual leave and absence notification rules for employees of Northstar Digital Services Ltd. employed in England and Wales during the period 1 January 2025 to 30 September 2026. Policy owner during its effective period: Head of People Services.

2 Annual leave entitlement (historical)

Table 2.1 — Annual leave entitlement under the superseded policy (1 January 2025 to 30 September 2026)

Continuous service completed	Annual leave days	Bank holidays	Total days
Less than 5 years	25	8	33
5 years or more	26	8	34

- The leave year ran from 1 January to 31 December.
- The 5-year service increment applied from the 1 January following the fifth anniversary of employment.
- **Part-time employees:** annual leave days = 25 x (contracted working days per week / 5), rounded to the **nearest** half day. Bank holidays falling on a part-time employee's working days were given as paid days off in addition.
- **Joiners and leavers:** entitlement = 25 x (complete calendar months of employment in the leave year / 12), rounded to the nearest half day.

3 Requesting leave (historical)

Table 3.1 — Notice for annual leave requests under the superseded policy

Length of leave	Minimum notice	Approver
Up to 5 working days	5 working days	Line manager
More than 5 working days	20 working days	Line manager
More than 10 consecutive working days	20 working days	Line manager and Head of Department

- Managers were expected to respond within **10 working days**.
- Leave could be taken in full or half days only. Hourly leave was not available.
- Leave could not be taken in advance of accrual beyond the annual entitlement, and negative balances were **not permitted**.

SUPERSEDED — NOT FOR CURRENT POLICY DECISIONS

4 Carryover (historical)

Up to **3 days** of unused annual leave could be carried into the next leave year and had to be taken by **28 February**. Leave not taken by 28 February was lost, except where statutory rules required carryover because of sickness or family-related leave. Any other carryover required Director of People Services approval.

5 Company shutdown (historical)

Employees reserved 3 days of annual leave for the office closure between Christmas and New Year. The 2025 shutdown dates were 29, 30 and 31 December 2025.

6 Absence notification (historical)

- Employees reported sickness absence by telephone to their line manager by **10:00** on the first day of absence.
- Self-certification covered absences of up to 7 calendar days; a fit note was required for longer absences.

7 Compassionate leave (historical)

Up to **3 working days** of paid compassionate leave were available on the death of an immediate family member, and 1 day to attend the funeral of another relative or close friend.

8 Document history

Table 8.1 — Document history, Leave Policy NDS-HR-LV-006

Version	Date	Status
1.0	Effective 1 January 2025	Approved by the Executive Leadership Team, 4 December 2024.
1.0	30 September 2026	Superseded with effect from 1 October 2026 by NDS-HR-LAS-002 v1.2 and NDS-HR-HB-001 v2.0. Archived.